

1. Quantum sensing I

Consider the sensing problem where we have a unitary $U_\phi = e^{-i\phi/2}|0\rangle\langle 0| + e^{i\phi/2}|1\rangle\langle 1|$, and wish to use a single quantum probe in the state $|+\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|0\rangle + |1\rangle)$ in order to learn information about ϕ . In this question we will consider performing a measurement of the operator $Y = |y+\rangle\langle y+| - |y-\rangle\langle y-|$, where $|y+\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|0\rangle + i|1\rangle)$ and $|y-\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|0\rangle - i|1\rangle)$.

- Calculate the probabilities to obtain the outcomes $+1$ and -1 when measuring the state $|\psi_\phi\rangle = U_\phi|+\rangle$. Use these probabilities to determine the expectation value $\langle Y \rangle_\phi$.
Hint: You may find it helpful to simplify your answer using the trigonometric identities $\cos(\alpha + \beta) = \cos \alpha \cos \beta - \sin \alpha \sin \beta$ and $\sin(\alpha + \beta) = \cos \alpha \sin \beta + \sin \alpha \cos \beta$.
- Calculate $\langle Y \rangle_\phi$ directly using the formula $\langle Y \rangle_\phi = \langle \psi_\phi | Y | \psi_\phi \rangle$ and $Y = i|1\rangle\langle 0| - i|0\rangle\langle 1|$, and verify that you obtain the same answer as in part (a).
- Show that $\Delta Y_\phi = |\cos \phi|$.
- Assume that ϕ is close to the value ϕ_0 , and the estimated expectation value is y_0 after N repetitions of the procedure. Calculate the sensitivity $\Delta\phi_0$ of this sensing protocol. How does it compare to the protocol based upon an X measurement from the notes?

2. Quantum sensing II

Consider the sensing problem where we have a unitary $U_\phi = e^{-i\phi/2}|0\rangle\langle 0| + e^{i\phi/2}|1\rangle\langle 1|$, and wish to use a single quantum probe in the state $|\chi_\theta\rangle = \cos \frac{\theta}{2}|0\rangle + \sin \frac{\theta}{2}|1\rangle$, with $0 \leq \theta \leq \pi$, in order to learn information about ϕ . In this question we will consider performing a measurement of the operator $X = |+\rangle\langle +| - |-\rangle\langle -|$, where $|+\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|0\rangle + |1\rangle)$ and $|-\rangle = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(|0\rangle - |1\rangle)$.

- Show that $\langle X \rangle_{\theta,\phi} = \sin \theta \cos \phi$, the expected value of the operator X when measured on the probe state after application of the unitary, $|\chi_{\theta,\phi}\rangle = U_\phi|\chi_\theta\rangle$.
- Show that $\Delta X_{\theta,\phi} = |\sin \phi| \sqrt{1 + \cos^2 \theta \cot^2 \phi}$ and that $\frac{\partial \langle X \rangle_{\theta,\phi}}{\partial \phi} = -\sin \theta \sin \phi$.
- Assume that ϕ is close to the value ϕ_0 , and the estimated expectation value is x_0 after N repetitions of the procedure. Calculate the sensitivity $\Delta\phi_0$ of this sensing protocol. How does it compare to the protocol based upon an X measurement from the notes when the probe state was $|+\rangle$? What happens when $\theta = 0$ or $\theta = \pi$. Does this make sense?

3. Quantum sensing III

Consider the sensing problem where we have a unitary $U_\phi = e^{-i\phi/2}|0\rangle\langle 0| + e^{i\phi/2}|1\rangle\langle 1|$, and wish to use an n -qubit quantum probe in the state $|\chi_\theta^n\rangle = \cos \frac{\theta}{2}|0\rangle^{\otimes n} + \sin \frac{\theta}{2}|1\rangle^{\otimes n}$, with $0 \leq \theta \leq \pi$, in order to learn information about ϕ .

- Show that we can prepare the state $|\chi_\theta^n\rangle$ by preparing $|\chi_\theta\rangle|0\rangle^{\otimes n-1}$, and successively applying CNOT unitary operators between the first and k^{th} qubit, for $2 \leq k \leq n$.
- Find the state of the n -qubit probe state, after it has probed the unitary, i.e. calculate $|\chi_{\theta,\phi}^n\rangle = (U_\phi \otimes \cdots \otimes U_\phi)|\chi_\theta^n\rangle$.
- By applying the sequence of CNOT unitary operators from part (a) in reverse order, show that we end up in the state $|\chi_{\theta,n\phi}\rangle|0\rangle^{\otimes n-1}$.
- Consider measuring X on the first qubit. Show that now $\langle X \rangle_{\theta,\phi} = \sin \theta \cos n\phi$, and $\Delta X_{\theta,\phi} = |\sin n\phi| \sqrt{1 + \cos^2 \theta \cot^2 n\phi}$.
- Assume that ϕ is close to ϕ_0 , and the estimated expectation value is x_0 after repeating the n -probe procedure N times. Calculate the sensitivity $\Delta\phi_0$ of this sensing protocol. How does it compare to the protocol from question 3?